Tier pack: Independent route — The local canvas: architectural line and form

Pathway: TRACK · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How can we use structural line, negative space, and surface frottage to record built architecture?

Independent route studio steps

Step 1: Create a zoned frottage ground combining two contrasting industrial textures.

Step 2: Map the overall proportions of an architectural span by sketching the negative-space sky shapes first.

Step 3: Develop the full structure using three distinct line weights (light guide, mid brace, heavy foreground girder).

Step 4: Add three technical annotations pointing to negative space, line weight, and surface texture.

Success check

Resolved architectural drawing over textured ground with three technical annotations.

Key words helper

• negative space: The open air gaps and shapes trapped between solid beams.

• truss: A rigid framework of steel or timber beams arranged in repeating triangles.

• line weight: Varying line thickness from light construction lines to heavy foreground edges.

• frottage: Taking a surface texture rubbing with graphite or wax over a relief surface.

• proportion: The size relationship between height, span, and beam thickness.

Review checklist

[ ] Check that the triangle sky gaps (negative spaces) match the angles on your reference card.

[ ] Verify that your nearest beams have the thickest, darkest lines.

[ ] Ensure your three technical labels point cleanly to the matching features.